

Annotation Guideline/User-Manual

The process of sentiment annotation consists of two sub-processes:

1. comprehension, in which the annotator understands the content, and
2. sentiment judgment, in which the annotator identifies the sentiment.

Using a 4-level scale (1—negative, 2—neutral, 3—positive, 4—mixed and 5—sarcasm), Please specify the evoked sentiment with the use of the following instruction:

“Please specify the sentiment from the perspective of an average Slovenian web user. How did you feel after reading this news?”

1. Positive Sentences should be tagged as positive.

Examples

- Vodafone ima še ogromno prostora za rast = Vodafone has vast room for growth
- Izvoz se je povečal za 4,5 odstotka = Exports increased by 4.5 percent.

2. Negative Sentence should be tagged as negative.

Examples

- Tanasic's name appeared in public after the robbery of the post office in Kresnice in June
- last year, in which Blaž Ereiz killed the postal employee Anica Likovič.
- Compared to the long-term average, the indicator was lower by 11 percentage points, the
- National Statistics Office announced today.
- **{Context should be taken into consideration}**

3. Facts should be neutral.

Examples

- In the latest report, Dolamič wrote that the company currently has no liquidity problems and pays its operating liabilities regularly.

4. Mixed class should be used for sentences will mixed polarity.

Example

- The dollar strengthened the value of the euro to \$ 1.357, and light oil prices fell below \$74.
- **In the case of compound-complex sentences with more than one sentiment expressed, such as a journalist's quotes and a politician's statements, we will assign the mixed sentiment class.**

5. Sarcasm class

- **The context should be taken into account, but always in accordance with the instructions given.**

Questions to be asked: What kind of language is the speaker using?

1. The speaker is using positive language, for example, expressions of support, admiration, positive attitude, forgiveness, fostering, success, positive emotional state => **POSITIVE**

‘Yay! France beat Germany 3–1’ will be marked as positive because the speaker is using the positive expression ‘Yay!’.

2. The speaker is using negative language, for example, expressions of criticism, judgment, negative attitude, questioning validity/competence, failure, negative emotion => **NEGATIVE**

The ‘Russia lost to Finland’ example will be marked as negative

3. the speaker is using expressions of sarcasm, ridicule, or mockery => **SARACSM**

Usually using positive words to convey negative emotion. Ex, “the President is doing such a "great" job,” but in a negative context. Please do consider the overall context of the document. This is easy for humans to annotate but difficult for computers.

4. the speaker is using positive language in part and negative language in part. => **MIXED**

There is an explicit or implicit clue in the text suggesting that the speaker is experiencing both positive and negative feelings

5. the speaker is neither using positive language nor using negative language. => **NEUTRAL**

These will be facts or no explicit or implicit sentiment bearing statements.